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Virginia Board of Education, Special Committee on Standards of Accreditation, Wednesday, November 18, 2020

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- Official meeting video (VDOE, YouTube): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=mAzST8Z4hFM
- Board of Education meetings, agendas and minutes (VDOE): https://www.doe.virginia.gov/state-board-data-funding/virginia-board-of-education

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Speech-to-text: whisper.cpp, model large-v3-turbo. Produced 2026-10-24. Each paragraph starts with its time [HH:MM:SS] in the meeting video.

[00:00:01] Good. Good to go. Wow, that was fast. Thanks, Kevin. Getting real good at this.

[00:00:44] All right, I'm trying. All right, we'll go ahead and do a screen share so our YouTube watchers know

[00:01:09] this is coming. All right, I'll be available if you need me. Just reach out. Okay, thanks, Kevin.

[00:01:24] Yeah, I'll text you if I need anything. We should be good. All right, no problem. Hi, Jamel. How are

[00:02:13] you? I'm good. How are you doing? Good. Good. Trying a new setup here. I always feel like I'm in the dark, literally. I will confess, a couple months back, I bought a ring light.

[00:02:34] Yeah, I've thought about it. I hesitated for so long. I was like, I'm not an influencer and a blogger and all that stuff, but my lighting, I was dark or orange or pink, and I was always a weird color, and so I bought one just from Amazon, and it works. Yeah, I think I'm gonna, you know, the longer we stay in this mode, I think I'm gonna have to invest in one. When I'm home, when I'm working from home, the way my windows are, the lighting is fine, but when I come here to the

[00:03:09] office for example yeah it's just obviously not right you know in any way and then you know kind of I'm looking at myself right now in the um in the squares and so like I'm looking off in some way I know I'm always I'm looking at the squares and not at the camera exactly I do the same thing yeah so anyway at some point maybe I'll figure it all out yeah probably by the time we're back in in the office is when we'll all figure it out.

[00:03:38] - Yeah, exactly. - All right, let's see who else we have. Just to let folks know, we are live and as soon as we have everybody jumped on, I'll pull down the screen share here.

[00:03:56] I just want folks that are watching our YouTube to know that this is the meeting that's coming up. Hi, Pam. - Hello, how's everybody? Hi, Pam. - Hey, Dan. - Hey, Pam, hi, Dan.

[00:04:11] - Deputy Secretary, are you there? - I just didn't know a deputy secretary. - I know not to speak. - You know not to speak? - I didn't know what to speak. No deputy secretary here, just a former has-been.

[00:04:31] - Yeah. - A has-been. - Still my favorite deputy secretary, Holly. - It's always nice when you become a has-been, Holly, speaking from experience. - Yeah, I follow in quite the footsteps here. to say better to be a has-been than i never was so how are you doing dan doing great thanks

[00:04:57] dr pexton can you hear us hi how are you hey good hello dr lane's here uh just to let folks know we are live streaming on youtube um as soon as we have everybody on i'll pull the the screen share off i just wanted our youtube watchers to know that this is the meeting that's coming up at two um while we're waiting can i did not see the minutes from the october meeting did i miss

[00:05:36] something let me double check if that is the case that is my mistake or maybe i'm just not in the right place they are linked so in your board book they so there's a link to them okay and they're also um at the bottom of that page too of the board book or or of your uh of the email that you sent of the board book so like i'll find it i'll find it in um your committee materials for today okay is where it's linked and then obviously tomorrow's minutes are also linked in your

[00:06:12] november 19th uh meeting materials yeah i always tend to go to the um to the public site for those those um we have a request and to get those posted so that's probably why you don't see those yet it takes us um our webmaster has a large influx right now so we're just a little bit behind on

[00:06:34] getting everything posted that's okay thank you look at those really quickly looks like we are

[00:06:59] just waiting on dr duran to join us and then we'll get started all right dr pexton it is two o'clock

[00:08:16] and i know we all like to be very prompt um so i'm gonna stop screen share here so that everybody can see each other um and i'll go ahead and turn it over to you okay thank you hello good afternoon it's good to see everybody um i just want to thank you for joining us for a meeting of a special committee to review the standards of accreditation um today's meeting is our last meeting of 2020

[00:08:49] believe it or not um this has felt like about the longest year probably of all of our lives um but i before we dive into the meeting that being said i do want to thank both um our committee members uh the bdoe staff and the public for their engagement uh over the past six months we've covered a lot of ground and since our committee since our excuse me since our committee began back in June. And I do want to give a special thanks to Dr. Jamel Wilson for stepping

[00:09:24] in for me last month when I was a little under the weather or a lot under the weather at Newport New Shipbuilding. We call that good watch team backup. And so I'm grateful for that support

from my committee team members. And so looking forward to the discussion today. So before I provide a brief synopsis of our presentations and work to date uh have committee members had a chance to review the minutes from the october 14th october 14th 2020 committee uh committee meeting looking

[00:09:57] for some universal nods there okay all right uh so with that uh can i get a motion to approve or amend the minutes motion to approve the minutes all right thank you dr dron can i get a second motion to second thank you miss davis fought uh we will do roll call vote uh miss davis fought aye dr duran aye dr wilson aye and my vote is i as well so that motion passes

[00:10:30] thank you um our committee's work began back in june uh the committee's objective was has always been to conduct a review of the newly implemented accreditation system to assess its anticipated positive negative and unintended outcomes of performance indicators some of the considerations included the board's soq and equity work complexity of the system and alignment with federal requirements at the committee's june meeting we received a staff presentation on the school to

[00:11:05] school accreditation process and the 2017 revisions to the standards of accreditation the committee also held a work session to develop our work plan if you guys remember my over-engineered shipyard plan that we would try to help be our guiding path to get started for the coming months and then at the july meeting the committee continued its discussion on the development of that work plan and potential topic areas for review and consideration in august the committee meant to receive two presentations a comprehensive presentation from staff with an overview of the

[00:11:41] SOA in its entirety where they where we walked through each part of the SOA and the 2017 revisions a state accreditation data review that focused on data that reflected possible impacts of changes to the SOA and update on school quality actions and technical assistance as a result of those 2017 changes additionally the committee received a presentation from the education committee Commission of the States, the ECS, and that ECS team provided an overview of school accountability

[00:12:17] systems across the country, including examples of school quality indicators from a number of states. At our September meeting, staff provided a presentation on the federal accountability requirements under ESSA and Virginia's school accreditation system. This presentation allowed us to dive deeper into how Virginia meets the federal accountability requirements and to better understand the differences between our accreditation system and federal accountability.

[00:12:47] This meeting also allowed us to host a panel discussion, probably two of the most engaging opportunities we had as a committee. One panel discussion with superintendents and principals who shared their views on the positive, negative, and unintended consequences of the 2017 SOA revisions, and that included their insights into school accreditation and policies and practices that have changed in field because of the revisions which I think we all found very helpful to hear and then our October meeting allowed the committee to learn more from the VDOE's internal staff work group on SOA

[00:13:26] implementation and their presentation to the committee included background information on certain unintended consequences from the 2017 revisions and possible solutions for the committee to consider. Additionally, we hosted another stakeholder panel with representatives from the Virginia Education Association, the Virginia School Board Association, the Virginia PTA, Virginia ASCD, the Virginia School Counselors Association, and Dr. Alan Siebert, co-chair of the

[00:13:58] Accreditation Task Force. In early 2021, the committee will again hear from BDOE's internal work group on recommended language changes to the SOA and will also receive an update on the work around a definition and data collection on students with limited or interrupted formal education and students with interrupted formal education. So we know this is an area of particular interest for the committee. So for today's work session what I would like us to do is considering all the

[00:14:34] information that we've been privileged to really kind of come to understand and learn more about I think this is a good time at the end of the year to kind of center up on our committee's work to date to discuss and to hear from the committee members and myself what were some key themes that we heard throughout all the presentations and panel discussions, some areas where there are some gaps in information that we still would like to learn more about, some possible revision areas for consideration if we have some ideas to throw out at this point, and some next steps for the committee as we move into 2020.

[00:15:11] And additionally, this will be a good time for me as the committee chair just to really make sure and to hear from you if there are other areas in our work plan that need some revision, meaning changes to our focus, discussion, considerations, etc.

[00:15:28] This would be an appropriate time to discuss that. So this is really a working meeting, just really an opportunity to hear from each other. Hopefully you guys have pulled up all your notes from the past five months and hopefully you can read them. I couldn't read some of them that I made myself, but this is just our time to center up and just kind of really see where we are as a committee.

[00:15:51] So with that, I'm going to open the floor to the committee chairs and of course to board members alike that are in attendance just to see where we could start with some initial feedback and some initial thoughts on the things that we've learned in the past few months.

[00:16:06] and i will be taking copious notes so dr pexton um i'll start with just a general observation of the i guess the value that i have found in hearings not only staff talk about how they have been focusing on the 2017 revision you know from its beginning from its inception

[00:16:46] to now and the potential solutions that they've provided to us but more so hearing directly from our principals and our superintendents and our other professional organization partners has been incredibly enriching and as i said in one of the meetings i can't remember which one I think we should be willing and excited to continue to hear from them as we think about

[00:17:18] potential changes or strategies for addressing what we would identify as unintended consequences of the SOA and then thinking even more creatively perhaps about going forward. So generally considering where we all find ourselves across the Commonwealth with the impact of COVID, I think about, you know, while it is an episode, so to speak, the consequences, the impact will be

[00:17:52] felt for years to come. And so I just think ensuring that we stay close to folks in the field will be very important. Mr. Gecker and I had a similar conversation to this over the last several hours and so i just want to bring that here to the group as something to to enter into the conversation at the appropriate time and as we think about the soa generally thanks dr wilson i think that's a very relevant comment you know i recall back when we first started this discussion back in june um there you know i don't know how to characterize i don't know if i would characterize

[00:18:27] it as uh we were sensitive to covid and the impact on this discussion in this review but we also kind of wanted to keep it somewhat separate uh from what i recall just to just to make sure we were really doing a a concentrated review of of of the the changes that were made uh we're six months later now and covet is just as much if not more proven that to your point it's it's it's really going to have implications for a long time to come so i think you're right that that connection

[00:19:00] to the public is probably going to continue to become more and more important as time moves on. Thanks for that point. I would just like to add to that and to say that what I really appreciate about the panels and what I think we need to continue to think about. One thing we heard was maintaining a level of consistency and accountability for making sure our students are successful. It was a drive and a desire of everyone, but making sure that we do it in a well-balanced way and the question that we had asked Chair Pexton was really around what were

[00:19:38] the unintended consequences what were the things that worked well from this and I think one of the themes that stood out for me listening to several of the superintendents in particular was the attendance aspect and what could be looked at there in terms of making sure that we want students to be in attendance but that was an area that they wanted us to consider about how we might better approach the soas around that topic that was one thing for me certainly another theme for me was really thinking about our student achievement and overall performance are we really looking at growth in the way that we can we is it captured in the best way we heard a lot of

[00:20:17] positive thanks from many of our panel members that they saw growth measures as being an aspect that was really valued in this but also particularly and this is the area that i have product and when we think about our English learners how are we capturing their growth and really making sure that what we're asking in terms of accountability and what we're looking at in terms of accreditation is really in alignment with that our students are making growth in our English learners so that was a personal one for me obviously that I've talked about but it's also one I did we did hear from a couple of principals who spoke as well as a few of our administrators

[00:20:55] So by and large, I would say, back to what Dr. Wilson said, is staying connected with those that are directly in the field as we understand this is just the beginning and we don't have our first look at this and making sure we have that balance. Our students and staff really being able to use this information in a way to improve instruction and address those inequities and look at those gap areas.

[00:21:21] And if not, where are ways that we can better help with that? And so I really appreciated listening and learning from the different perspectives and this conversation and our work plan moving forward. I hope that we will be addressing a couple of those areas that was brought up as a potential unintended consequence, if you will.

[00:21:40] Thank you. Thank you, Dr. Drone. Dr. Paxton. Yes. I have enjoyed hearing from all of the people at the department who spoke with us and shared different perspectives across different states, especially for the thoughts of the non-academic indicators. I enjoyed hearing about what other states are doing in comparison to ours, and when we heard the state superintendents share their thoughts and the principals, something that

[00:22:18] I'm dealing with on myself as I'm thinking about, okay, non-academic standards, school accreditation, the current COVID crisis, equitable practices. And I keep going back in my thoughts and going back in our notes to think about what is it that we can do as a state to move forward to make sure

that everything that we do, we have a pulse check on. So it all ties in together and it's all this big web that we're focusing on and I'm very proud of what we're focusing on because I think it's it's a huge step forward so I thank everyone at the department for being so very generous with

[00:22:57] their time and and all of the superintendents and I think it's very important for us to think about the the accreditation and the non-academic indicators such as chronic absenteeism but I I would like to have a further conversation about how we can continue to keep a pulse check on school cultures and to make sure that all of our practices in place are actually having the impact that we would like for them to have as far as equity goes.

[00:23:28] So I'm still digesting all of this and there are times that something comes across that I stay literally stuck on and mull over and do some reading and whatnot, but I think it's something worth talking about is as a culture piece and a culture measurement just to make sure that we we're doing what we need to do at the at the division level and at the school level too thank you and and just for clarification when you refer to school culture you you that's in the same vein as school climate correct yeah okay so just make sure you weren't making a distinction

[00:24:04] it sounds the same but just make because that school climate was an area that i think that would be worthy of discussion as well. Thank you. Any other initial observations, areas that the board, any board members on the call heard? Many of you participated in the call and in several of the calls over the last couple of weeks, and I do want to consider any of that input if you have some. Well, I'll just chime in to say I was pleased to hear and actually

[00:24:40] pleasantly surprised to hear from the superintendents that they actually felt like the change has has felt like more of a movement to continuous quality improvement and that you know overall I mean obviously it's still in the early stages but that overall they seem encouraged about the changes so far I wasn't at all sure what to expect even though they helped us shape the changes

[00:25:09] there are a lot of moving pieces and a lot of it is still up for grabs in many ways in terms of how it all plays out. But the early responses from them of this is much better for us than the old regimen, I was pleased to hear that. Thank you, Ms. Holton. Any other feedback before I move on

[00:25:41] to my next discussion point so one thing to um add to the list of something to dig deeper on in the la our last meeting and i'm going to paraphrase horribly so forgive me but i believe um alan siebert suggested that perhaps we are at a place where we stop thinking about fixing what

[00:26:13] is and starting over now i think um but but i think it's worth at some point understanding more because in that meeting we didn't have a lot of time and i didn't hear a lot of detail but to consider um at what point have we tinkered around the edges as much as we can and will that tinkering yield the kind of results that we are hoping to re to to to achieve

[00:26:45] and if we realize that it's not then what is our readiness to then you know begin seriously to begin thinking again about what a structure might look like and so i just put that out there something that may be worth conversation it may be out of the purview of this group it may be out of our window of time but i am curious to hear more about what that might look or to think about what that

[00:27:10] could look like okay thank you uh any other thoughts or feedback from the board pride myself on being a good multitasker here okay um so in reviewing our work plan um which i'm happy to send out

once i've completed all of these notes and updated and made it look nicer than what it does just going back and really reviewing kind of where we started and some of our initial thoughts

[00:27:47] about what we thought we would want to learn more about i'd like to hear from the board you know on a scale of I feel good, I feel more informed versus I think I need more information. These were some of the additional key tasks or areas that we were wanting to hear more about. But if you feel like we put a check in that box based on the presentations that we received and the conversations that we had, then great. But if I mention something that you feel like maybe we need to add to the agenda in 2021, I'd like to hear from the board. So looking back at our notes,

[00:28:22] a couple of those things that i identified um there was a discussion early on about two particular indicators one we've talked about a little bit uh school climate um that did not i'm sorry two indicators that did not make the cut um in the initial 2017 soa revisions one was school climate which obviously miss davis bought has already said hey i think we have some more work to do discussions to have considerations to make there. The other one was student discipline and I put a note here being disproportional to black students and I'm going to list them all rather than going

[00:28:59] one by one and asking I'm just going to list them all and if something resonates with you please please let me know. So student discipline was the other piece. We heard from Mr. Siebert from the COVID accreditation task force we had a we had an item to say hey we'd like to hear from the task force do we feel like we need any concentrated discussion just with the covid task force uh in addition to what we we had with mr siebert and maybe that goes back to dr jamel's point so that was another item that i identified that that might be something we wanted to consider

[00:29:33] um another item was um uh looking at college career and civic readiness index and school's ability to meet this criteria in the current environment that was a note that i had here as well um i had a note here about uh the discussion around schools moving to competency based rather age-based um approach uh that was a note that i had so i'll pause there just on those initial notes and i'm going to go back to some i think i have a few more but i want to pause there just to see if if that resonates with the board as things you feel like because we've heard a lot

[00:30:12] of information so maybe somebody picked up on something that i didn't so um i think this idea of competency-based versus age-based I think that for me that is something that resonates as my wanting to know a bit more about especially though it's not necessarily completely attached you know just thinking about where we are with waivers with the way we are thinking about learning in this current academic year accreditation we're all having to rethink

[00:30:51] you know this school year and so is is a focus on toward competency-based understanding that a bit more may help inform much of what we may find ourselves in a position of grappling with so i would like to hear more about the competency base and i don't recall dr pexton that we had a significant amount of time with that so far since july okay dr wilson i'll echo that because I think one of the good suggestions that was made from our panelists was to go back and look at some

[00:31:26] of the work of the SL Innovation Committee on that very issue there and I don't think we've as this committee have not really dug deep into that I don't know maybe VDOE staff have done that as a result of that comment but um that I think would be another area for us to look look closer at so I want to echo Dr. Wilson just so I've got one little one and one bigger one my little one is have we heard about and so I've

been in some of the meetings but I may not have I may have come later left early so i mean i've been with you the whole time but have we talked about the the the

[00:32:01] college and career readiness indicator that is supposed to kick in soon i mean we've been collecting data on it but it hasn't yet factored into accountability if i'm correct um and how's that how's that coming how's work on that coming and how is it going to work and how are we doing rolling it out to the divisions. So I don't remember whether that's been a topic, but if not, it might be worth getting some review on that one since it's the last of the indicators to kick in.

[00:32:38] Oh, and my bigger one is just that, yeah, can we think about how to fold in some of the lessons from the COVID moment, which hopefully will be a moment, you know, a year from now? i'm optimistic with the latest vaccine news that we're going to be back to a more normal operation but with a lot of consequences enduring in all kinds of ways but maybe to what are some of the lessons and opportunities of the coveted moment for that longer term look that that alan siebert

[00:33:16] was suggesting we start to take and you know what do we what have we learned about parent engagement what have we learned about breaking down the walls of the building via technology what have we learned about personalized learning there's some there's some positive opportunity what have we learned about maybe not tying teacher more flexibility about the number of teaching hours versus preparation hours or or instruction hours other than classroom more flexibility on the classroom

[00:33:48] hours kinds of requirements that there may be some some positive lessons from this ungodly experience that we could fold into a longer term conversation about what would it look like to start from scratch so i i saw some nods from the board members on the first uh what miss holton clarified or represented as uh the smaller ask um and i'll be honest with you i was scanning my notes trying

[00:34:21] to see if i recalled that conversation um if either one of the nods or emily or someone could speak to that that would be beneficial to start with her first question so i i going back in some of my notes i don't think we've covered the college and career and civic readiness index as much as we can i think there have been some mentions of it but i don't think we've done a a deep dive to give you all an update on where we are with that it comes on board can't remember if it's next year

[00:34:57] or the year after i believe it's 22 when it would come on board based on the four-year cohort data so we can certainly work on that from a staff perspective to bring you an update in early 2021 thank you emily dr lane we can't hear you i see you're talking sorry i was muted twice on phone and screen. But to the latter part of Secretary Holton's question, I think one of the big things

[00:35:32] we've learned in COVID that the board should explore is, you know, whether all the rules we have in place on time and space are relevant anymore in the future. I will say on one hand, I think the minimum core instructional hours allowed us to ensure that core instruction move forward uh and then some of it's in the code like the 990 but but is 680 hours the right number uh is is uh the the notion that things have to happen in a certain amount of time correct and then um you know are the class sizes and all of these things still relevant that that's

[00:36:11] in a lot of that is in the soq and the soa and so it you know it might cross into certain thresholds But I think that that would be one of the biggest things from COVID that we've learned is that the structure of educating students in 45-minute blocks every day might no longer be a requirement from the state, and there might be other ways to open up flexibility so that can be done in multiple different ways.

[00:36:38] Now, that's a rabbit hole you really haven't started to go down, but I think you heard a little bit of that from Dr. Kisner, and it's probably worth exploring again. Dr. Lane, to your point, I would want to make sure that any deep dive or review or, you know, crystal balling we do also consider the equity gaps that we know we have or the access gaps that already exist and how changes may either mitigate or exacerbate the gaps that are there, right?

[00:37:17] so so i would want to make sure that we hear as much as we can about all sides of that issue um you know kind of eyes wide open kind of approach and related to that i it might be time for standards around what the minimum expectation around virtual learning might look like should we ever have to do this again in the future oh in all of this aren't we at the end of the day concerned most about what the outcomes are for the kids and you know frankly the pandemic is

[00:37:52] you know with everything essentially waived is not providing really any you know enough data to see what the outcomes are how they've changed uh you know to me the whole purpose of the accreditation system was to ensure that the adults were doing what they were supposed to do for the kids right i mean it was to put in place a system that's either you're doing it well or you're not doing well and you know as we talk about these factors and i know i'm not on the committee but it would be helpful if we related the factors we're talking about whether it be seat time or

[00:38:30] uh you know quality virtual and all these things that we're going to put in a new system uh to how it impacts the educational achievement of our children you know i understand school climate for example is important because if you have happy teachers you have better educated and in theory students right but to you know continue to draw the linkage between what it is we're measuring and you know student outcome i think would be very helpful not just for me but for you know a lot of folks looking in on us to further your point um president gecker's the

[00:39:09] school climate and the school culture is a a broad measure of equity as far as the accessibility to to education to the learning to the practices to working with others being able to such as culturally responsive culture responsive teaching is it is it actually being delivered is it actually being encouraged in the classroom so that the child feels like they're part of the

[00:39:44] greater picture so also restorative practices and discipline strategy so in order at the grassroots level in order for a child to succeed in a classroom you've got to have all of those basic factors in place so that their mind is freed up in order to take on that new level of instruction so so that's that's in furtherance of that point so i i did have a few additional items to just reconcile against our initial thoughts but while we're on this topic one additional point i was

[00:40:19] going to bring up as relative to this discussion just to get the board's thoughts on where it fits was the information received that we received i believe it was was last week um about uh school segregation and boundary lines um in virginia and the impact of those school boundaries on on on equity uh and many many board members may recall receiving that um and what i thought was really telling in that article that i read and i highlighted it is is that it said in this

[00:40:55] report we're trying to think about the local level and the state level simultaneously in terms of how to make policy to support reducing segregation virginia is really is a really opportune place to do that because of its diversity and it can and should be a model for other states to constructively address changing demographics to reduce inequality so i i bring that up just because i intended to and also because of the nature of this discussion but just wanted to get the board's initial thoughts

[00:41:26] from from reading that and also uh implications for this work i think that's a great topic to think about in the sort of longer term and and frankly that we as the board are we we may have more authority in that than we have exercised in the past our constitutional authority to define divisions even or there's some language like that and you know we wouldn't want to throw throw that around lightly but to think about what authority

[00:42:01] we might have to impact to hold divisions accountable for how uh boundary decisions influence outcomes i think it's a great idea thank you i would i mean if it's okay Dr. Pexton. This topic did come up on the legislative briefing. We did last week, sometime Thursday, I guess. And the question was asked specifically of us, what could the board do

[00:42:34] more? And frankly, our ability to set boundary lines in the constitution is where division lines is subject to criteria set by the assembly. One of those criteria right now is that both the school division and the governing body of the jurisdiction where the school division is have to agree.

[00:42:55] And so effectively our power has been taken away, if you will, by that provision. In addition, something that we talked about at one of our meetings when we were actually meeting in person, which seems like a lifetime ago, was we are expected to do a review and report on the impact of the division lines on the achievement of the standards of quality.

[00:43:23] To the best of my knowledge, when the question was asked, and I think, you know, Steve Staples was still superintendent for part of this, we have never done it. I know, James, you and I have talked about it before. I think it would be very helpful if, you know, this topic moves forward, and I know it's a little bit off point for the accreditation committee, but that the board and the staff begin to undertake a review of current division lines and how they impact, you know, our efforts to achieve the standards of quality throughout the Commonwealth. You know, we noted

[00:43:56] this in, if you recall, in the 2017 comprehensive work plan document, the issue of increasing segregation is, you know, highlighted in there as an issue that we're looking to address. And so I'm happy to see it coming back again. I'm happy to see the report, you know, providing the statistics to verify what we knew back then, but it would be good for us to move forward on this, I think, whether through this committee or otherwise.

[00:44:25] Thank you, President Gecker. Dr. Pexton, I certainly support that. I think that would be an exceptional body of work to undertake for how challenging it's been to even get the requisite resources required to address the standards of quality.

[00:44:47] It seemed that something like this could afford an opportunity to go with that in a way that would be within our authority to do so. So I appreciate that point being articulated in that way.

[00:45:09] JoAnne Hanrahan: A just an observation or a suggestion is thinking about where does that that does that going down that. JoAnne Hanrahan: Review and consideration is that part of what we would do here in this committee is that work for the broader board to undertake so just bring that back to you know let's figure out where.

[00:45:31] We don't want to get sidetracked from the work that we're doing in this committee if it is helpful, certainly, but if it if the conversation is more useful to be had at the board level, rather than the committee level i'll encourage us to think about kind of placement of the discussion.

[00:45:50] Thanks for pointing that out yeah I from a chair standpoint, I feel like there's implications of that work to this committee I don't know that is that it is directly the work of this committee. So, and what those implications are, I think, would become more apparent as the board continue to work through that discussion and so that that would be my.

[00:46:15] Initial thought, but I do think it's it was a it's a relevant discussion that we need to keep in our purview and sounds like there's consensus on that, but thank you for making that point, Dr was my view from my perspective, unless there's some opposition see that as a broader discussion.

[00:46:31] JoAnne Hanrahan: yeah and I do think it does have implications for ultimately where this committee would land or recommend or inform the recommendations, but you know or how that how it fits, so I appreciate that. Definitely. So there's no more discussion on that topic. I had a couple more just reconciliations of our thoughts from before.

[00:46:58] If you feel like we've checked the box, then great. If you feel like it's something we still need to be considering or need to hear more about, this is the opportunity to indicate it. So my notes that we had indicated, and these are kind of a little bit cryptic notes, a little incomplete, but we had talked about growth measures not applying to the third grade yet.

[00:47:18] We had talked about why do we not have anything relative to teacher quality measures. And we had talked about how do we know the resource allocation component is effective. Those were the last three items that I highlighted for validation that the committee felt like we had sufficient information or information at all on.

[00:47:42] Initial thoughts? Dr. Pexton, can you read that first one again? I just want to make sure I'm capturing it in my notes, too. Yep. Growth measures do not apply to third grade yet.

[00:47:58] So I'd like to hear more about where we are generally with growth measures overall. Certainly third grade, but just in general growth measures and kind of progress that we've made to date. So I'll second that as something to circle back on.

[00:48:17] I agree, Dr. Paxton. That's a good point. Thank you. Any other thoughts there?

[00:48:33] Okay. before I do a review kind of of what I heard and captured as far as what additional information we would like to hear and learn about and kind of where we feel we are, I do want to ask again, other than the position of I think we need to talk about that more, was there any definitive topic that relative to the work of our committee? And to that point, I do want to re-read

[00:49:07] our objective, you know, our original charter objective was to conduct a review of the newly implemented accreditation system to assess anticipated positive, negative, and unintended outcomes of performance indicators, consider data, consider data available since implementation, as well as current state affairs, validate efficient progress towards original intended outcomes. We put a parenthesis to review that comment, but basically we knew we wanted to really validate opposite of the time that it's been in place and the information that was available

[00:49:42] the in the effectiveness of the indicators and provide system change recommendations if warranted are there any explicit uh topics that we feel we absolutely need to make a recommendation on and maybe we don't know what that recommendation is yet maybe we know that but is there anything that

resonated with anyone that says, hey, as a negative outcome or as an unintended outcome, other than we've talked about attendance and some other things, we want to look at more. Is there

[00:50:16] anything else explicit that stood out? And this may not be the time. It could come later, but I just want to make sure that we capture that if it is. I'll just reiterate the notion of the dropout rate and the implications for students with limited experience formal education. It's like students.

[00:50:43] i'm sorry repeat that one more time notion the dropout rate and the dropout rate indicator and the implications around um students with limited interrupted formal education or slife s-l-i-f-e right which we okay thank you and and we will get some more additional information on that and so we do have action on that in 2021 thank you dr pexton the last time we met i i put in a request and i know that we don't have currently have that information but i would really like to to see a map and and see where these children are located which divisions with

[00:51:20] which districts where where are these children what's the impact and and what is it that we can do um as a board our legacy how can we help these children what is it that we can do to to make sure that um when when it's all said and done that we get the results that we want for these children and to clarify that's a map of this life and and um life yeah and that's you know that's one of the challenges we have right now we don't have a definition for these students which means we don't collect the data which means we cannot produce the map but hopefully you know we can

[00:51:58] provide you that update in what that definition may be and kind of the progress towards that um hopefully at our january meeting so are these terms that are being used in in other states other organizations are these just terms particular to our discussion about our needs in our state in our areas um so just one aside there uh um the state is fought is that um the general assembly did require us to create a definition uh that is that is coming forward to you as emily mentioned

[00:52:36] than the near future. We're just about wrapped up with that. And then once we have a clear definition of it, then we'll put it into our student record collections and then we can produce a map. Our definition is the one that we're going to be bringing to you is pretty well aligned to what other states that have been a little further ahead are doing on this. We're obviously not bringing you policy recommendations yet in terms of how you might handle that with graduation rates or testing but we just want to make sure you're clear on what the definition of a student that falls into this category is then we'll start collecting data on it and in the meantime uh

[00:53:15] as you go through the soa you'll use that definition should you uh should you agree with our definition of it uh to to make policy decisions about how those students would be impacted in a variety of factors but uh that that clarity around the definition is going to be essential and we're we've wrapped up that work at the department level and we'll we'll be bringing that to you in the near future. And ideally, we will be able to, as Dr. Lane mentioned, put it in the spring SRC if we, you know, can get settled on that definition in early 2021. Thank you. I

[00:53:49] appreciate that description. Thank you. All right. Any other comments relative to my original question? Okay. So what I'd like to do is just kind of review what I've captured as far as where we feel we are as a committee, as far as what our priority focuses need to be moving forward into 2021. And so if I misrepresent or leave anything off, please interrupt me so I can

[00:54:24] correct it in the moment and then make sure we're good to go. And so we, you know, I'm I'm going by my notes here, by who spoke, but so it looks more understood we do want to dig a little deeper into, you know, the broader discussion around.

[00:54:46] Is it time to stop just kind of fixing iterative iteratively the system that's in place or considering our current climate. do we really need to be looking at maybe of a wholesale change in our SOA approach and we're curious to hear more about what others think about that, maybe from the public, maybe from the COVID task force committee, maybe other resources that the BDOE might be able to recommend.

[00:55:18] We'd like to hear more about competency versus age-based model and considering the waivers and accreditations and having to rethink our whole approach to the school year we'd like to dig a little bit more into that we need to consider the equity gaps that already exist and how any changes or impacts that that we make or that are maybe in place already could continue if not now later have some perpetual impact on those equity gaps from a school boundary standpoint we determined

[00:55:56] that that is not the primary work of this committee but it has implications for the work of this committee um and so we do feel like that that's an area of discussion that needs to possibly happen in tandem with the board or while at least in the time frame that this committee is doing its work so that we can make sure our work is relevant to that um we'd like to hear more about where we are overall on growth measures not just in particular grades um and we do feel like we need to take a

[00:56:30] closer look at the attendance aspect of our of our indicators and how it's impacting uh current state uh uh deployment of the 2017 soas um back piggybacking on my comment before about student achievement and growth there was a comment about are we really looking at that the right way if we're if if we have additional discussions or when we have additional discussions about growth measures are we looking at it the right way how are we capturing growth for el for english

[00:57:02] language learners um and so we want some additional uh discussion and understanding there uh we want to further our conversation on how we really are keeping a pulse check on school culture slash school climate and the implications of that to the soas we just talked about the slice of students and additional information that we're going to get from a definition standpoint and then from a data standpoint down the road uh we'll learn about that in in in like

[00:57:36] likely in january or first of the year from the bdoe uh it sounds like we would like to have an update just on how things are coming on the college and civic and career readiness indicator that was that's supposed to kick in soon it appears the board would benefit just from just a refresher and really kind of understanding where that's at and we want to think about how we can this kind of maybe goes back to the big broader discussion about the soas we want to think about how we could fold some of our lessons learned and

[00:58:13] opportunities as a result of COVID intentionally into better SOA, maybe not better, but more impactful SOA standards for the Commonwealth. And in that vein, we want to know what have we learned about parent engagement, personalized learning, virtual learning, teaching versus preparation hours and what room do we have there for some more flexibility uh dr lane expanded on that about

[00:58:47] looking at um whether the rules we have in place on time and space are relevant in the future you know talking about the 680 hour rule um and do we have do does does that have to happen in a certain

time that we have uh already predicated um we talked we also would like to talk about um um maybe that it's time to consider what standards are in place for in the future around virtual

[00:59:17] learning um and um dr president gecker pointed out that we actually as a as a board uh do have uh expectate are expected of us to do a review of the impact of the boundary lines that we discussed earlier and how they may impact our standards of equality that we had not done it yet so that again goes more so to some activity that we should consider on the board that might impact the work of this committee so that is what i've captured as far as centering up on the past six months of

[00:59:56] discussion is there anything that i've missed or anything that i've misrepresented in that assessment Dr. Paxton, you did an outstanding job overview of what we've talked about. I just want to clarify, and I think it was implied in what you were saying about the climate and culture piece, but I thought it'd be important just to double down a little bit, and maybe I don't recall you said this if you did, I apologize, really about the chronic absenteeism indicator itself as it relates to what we're looking at. I don't know if you said that I didn't hear that part, so

[01:00:31] I just thought that was important to make sure. I think we heard that loud and clear for multiple participants and the panels um that i think it's something we should look deeper at so okay yeah no thanks for clarifying that uh that was in my mind under the the attendance aspect bullet but you're right i do want to call that out um distinctly thank you keisha i would just add i i think you had this but the the notion of tinkering changes versus wholesale changes

[01:01:05] it could be a both and could be where we end up that the the more wholesale changes is going to be a longer term endeavor but we may want to get with feedback we may want to get started on it sooner rather than later at the same time that we make some smaller change recommendations for smaller changes good point thank you any other suggestions emily i saw you fervently writing and taking notes i do plan on sharing my notes with you as soon as i can clean them up all right

[01:01:44] um so i anticipated this meeting would be likely an hour um i know sometimes i can get long-winded so i told emily to schedule it for an hour and a half um but i just i do want to just give one last opportunity you know we've we still have you know likely in my opinion several months of of discussion and observations and feedback to get from the public to really kind of come through this before we really get to some if any uh you know discrete recommend you know specific recommendations uh but again i just wanted to use this as a centering moment we've gotten so much

[01:02:21] information and wanted to do a data dump wanted to hear what was in the minds of the other committee members and just really reconcile us against our original thoughts and so just uh just want to give one final opportunity for any additional thoughts or suggestions for our 2021 committee work committees going to be busy and staff's going to be busy yep i'm on page three great leadership keisha thank

[01:02:56] you great well uh i appreciate again like i said in the beginning i really do appreciate the the the contributions of the committee uh the board members the the video staff um in this important work uh it's almost a little bit of a moving target with the environment that we're living in right now but i'm grateful uh to be to be navigating this work with the with the folks on the on the call today so i'd like to thank everyone for your for your robust input and

[01:03:30] discussions uh our next meeting will be january 27th um in 2021 that that just floors me to say that um but uh with that being said i do want to wish everyone a wonderful holiday season i'm going to ask and pray that everyone stays safe um and that you enjoy your families virtually um just like we are enjoying our family right now virtually um and that i look forward to seeing you guys at the first of the year thank you very much this concludes our meeting thank you so much everybody will convene for the board's business meeting tomorrow at 10. thanks everybody thank you everyone



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